

Additional Committee Considerations

(Items discussed but no action taken or recommendation made.)

AGENDA

- The committee reviewed the Conference Evaluation Form and agreed that the questions remain the same for the 49th General Service Conference Evaluation Form.
- The committee considered the Composition, Scope and Procedure and agreed to revise the sections on Composition and Scope to better reflect current practice, and to also update the language in the Procedure section.
- The committee asked the staff secretary to prepare a form to be sent out each September 1st to all Conference members to gather suggestions for the Conference theme, presentations and workshop topics.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee reviewed the draft for a pamphlet developed to replace the existing pamphlet "If You Are a Professional" and agreed there is no need for the new material at this time.
- The committee reviewed the C.P.C. Kit and requested the suggested addition to the C.P.C. Workbook regarding working with students of professional schools be implemented at the next printing.
- The committee encourages A.A. members to bring students of professional schools to their open A.A. meetings.
- The committee discussed C.P.C. participation in the development of future Membership Surveys, and agreed to take no action at this time.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES:

- The committee suggests that a new section, entitled "Carrying the Message into Youth Detention Centers and Short-Term Facilities," be added to the contents section of the Correctional Facilities Workbook and that the new section follow the section "How to do Correctional Facilities Work."
- The committee reviewed the trustees' Committee on Correctional Facilities' report on literature review and saw no need for action at this time.
- The committee suggested that an informational letter from the General Service Office to correctional professionals be further developed as a one-page document and brought back to the 1999 Conference Committee on Correctional Facilities, along with projected costs of production and distribution.
- The committee considered a suggestion that the Correctional Facilities Workbook be designated as service material rather than A.A. Conference-approved literature and decided it should remain A. A. Conference-approved.

FINANCE

- The committee unanimously suggested that Birthday Plan envelopes continue to be sent to delegates annually.

- The committee unanimously suggested G.S.O. develop a method for measuring the use of Birthday envelopes and report the results to the delegates.
- The committee had a wide ranging discussion of the principle of Self-Support, with special emphasis on how the topic relates to the Conference theme: "Our Twelfth Step Work."

Much of the discussion revolved around the importance of increasing participation of individuals and groups in all levels of service. Contributions are but one form of participation that make it possible for one alcoholic to carry the message to another. The committee unanimously agreed that delegates can play a key role in increasing self-support by:

- a) Promoting the Birthday Plan, and
- b) Emphasizing Twelfth Step work made possible by contributions; for example, the work we do to provide translations of A.A. literature in foreign languages that then reach populations that have never before heard the A.A. message of recovery and hope.

The committee recognizes that Self-Support and the spiritual principle of sacrifice on which it is based must be continually communicated.

- The committee reviewed the action taken by the 1997 General Service Conference concerning the board policy that states:

Whenever a discount or subsidy is that which would be offered to any other organization of similar size requiring a purchased service or product of similar character and magnitude, i.e., convention rates at hotels, it may be accepted. Whenever a discount or subsidy is partly or in total offered because we are Alcoholics Anonymous, it must be declined.

The 1997 General Service Conference voted not to change this policy. With substantial unanimity, the committee felt there was no need to reconsider this decision.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee considered several suggestions for related items for production in the year 2000 and forwarded to the Grapevine Corporate Board their suggestion that one item be developed: a soft-cover anthology, tentatively called *AA Around the World*, comprised of Grapevine articles.
- The committee also wished to suggest to the Grapevine Corporate Board that an anthology of letters previously published in the Grapevine be considered for publication at a future date.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/REGIONAL FORUMS

- The committee discussed suggestions for future Regional Forums and encouraged the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums to consider the possibility of having more frequent and accessible Forums within a region.

LITERATURE

- The committee suggested that the service piece developed to accompany the video *Your A.A. General Service Office, the Grapevine and the General Service Structure* be available as a separate item.
- The committee considered a request from an area that the six-point definition of an A.A. group be added to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, replacing the section from Warrant Six added by the

1997 General Service Conference, and concurred with the trustees' Literature Committee's conclusion that "The A.A. Group" pamphlet remain as is.

- The committee considered a request for Conference approval of a pamphlet submitted by an area, "The Twelfth Step Call: A Brief Guide," and applauded the intent and effort put into the development of this material, but took no action on this item. The consensus of the committee was that this was a local service piece, and that A.A. members should be encouraged to do Twelfth Step work through sponsorship, workshops, and the chapter, "Working With Others," in the Big Book.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The Conference Policy/Admissions Committee did their inventory and felt the committee is serving a vital purpose in accordance with its scope.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee discussed the 1997 and current reports on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site activity and acknowledged the effectiveness of the A.A. Web Site as a valuable Public Information tool in carrying the message and providing opportunities for local Twelfth Step work.
- The committee reviewed the contents of the Public Information Kit and Workbook and suggested that the trustees' Public Information Committee thoroughly review the contents of the A.A. Fact File.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee discussed a review of the *A.A. Service Manual*, undertaken by the Publications Department of the General Service Office, suggested a number of editorial changes and requested that a completed second draft be prepared for consideration by the 1999 Conference Report and Charter Committee.
- The committee considered a proposal to change the format or to discontinue the group directories for the U.S. and Canada. The committee felt the directories should be continued and that there should be no changes in the format at this time.
- The committee considered a request to list an on-line intergroup as an intergroup on G.S.O.'s A.A. Web Site. The committee took no action, reaffirming Advisory Action #32 of the 1997 General Service Conference that "intergroups serving on-line meetings be listed adjacent to on-line A.A. meetings in the section on International Correspondence." The committee felt that on-line intergroups have been placed in the appropriate place in the directories.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee discussed creating a list of suggested goals for Treatment Facilities committees and requested that the committee secretary distribute a preliminary list of suggested goals for Treatment Facilities committees to all delegates and Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople on G.S.O.'s mailing list.
- The committee discussed Area Temporary Contact/Bridging the Gap efforts and shared on a wide range of experience and suggested that this experience be included in a future edition of *Box 4-5-9* and be added to the Treatment Facilities Workbook.

- The committee discussed Treatment Facilities Activity Reports from the Treatment Facilities coordinator to all Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople and asked that these reports also continue to be sent to area delegates. The committee requested that the committee secretary distribute the G.S.O. mailing list of Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople to all area delegates for their information, updating and review.

- The committee discussed the results of the November 1997 request to Treatment Facilities committees for sharing on carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals. The committee noted that these responses represented a wide variety of personal experience and the responses give a sense of what's happening across the United States and Canada. The committee discussed the continuing need to concentrate on this kind of sharing and exchange of information. These responses show committees at different levels of service experience. The responses appear to be an accurate inventory of the strengths and weaknesses in carrying the message into psychiatric/mental health facilities or state hospitals.

- The committee requested that the summary of responses to the November 1997 Treatment Facilities Questionnaire be condensed and rewritten for the Treatment Facilities Workbook and that this revised summary of responses be presented to the 1999 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee for their review.

- The committee discussed the 1997 Policy/Admissions Committee's suggestion that each Conference committee inventory itself. As a result of this discussion and after a second review of this committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure, the committee agreed to revise the second paragraph of the Scope, "The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups in treatment facilities and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements" to read, "The committee will review all aspects of service to A.A. groups/meetings in treatment facilities and other noncorrectional institutional environments and make recommendations for changes and/or improvements."

The committee also agreed that discussion of their agenda items covered all aspects of this committee's inventory.

- The committee reviewed and accepted the Treatment Facilities Workbook (three-ring binder) and Treatment Facilities Handbook with minor changes.
- The committee requested that a questionnaire be circulated to all delegates and Treatment Facilities committee chairpeople to request sharing on carrying the message into noncorrectional youth facilities and that a summary of responses be reviewed by the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee and the 1999 Conference Treatment Facilities Committee.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Treatment Facilities Committee consider developing a Treatment Facilities tabletop display for use by local Treatment Facilities committees.

TRUSTEES

- The committee strongly suggested that the trustees' Nominating Committee remove the following diversity statement from the four vacancy announcement letters for regional trustee, trustee-at-large, Class A trustee and appointed committee member:

Note: At its August 1997 meeting, the trustees' Nominating Committee expressed overall concern that, as a Fellowship, we need to be mindful of attracting women and people of color to serve the Fellowship when vacancies occur, recognizing that diversity is a key factor in the unity of the Fellowship.



While the committee recognizes the Fellowship's need to attract the most diverse and qualified trusted servants in the service structure to serve Alcoholics Anonymous, enumerating diversity in announcing vacancies is not within the spirit of A.A. unity.

- In taking the committee's inventory, it was felt that under the Composition section of the Composition, Scope and Procedure document, an attempt should be made to ensure that regions with small numbers of delegates avoid duplication on Conference committee assignments.

Under the Scope section of its Composition, Scope and Procedure, the committee expressed a desire to continue to review resumes of appointed committee members but questioned the purpose of the review.

The committee found the Procedure section of its Composition, Scope and Procedure to be acceptable as written.

- The committee discussed the demands of time and energy required to serve as a regional trustee and felt that this topic needed ongoing discussion. The committee noted with appreciation that the board was looking into restructuring the board weekends.

- With regard to future growth of the Conference, the committee thanked the trustees' Nominating Committee for their work on developing the process for requesting new delegate areas and regional realignment. This had been recommended by the trustees' Nominating Committee as follows:

- 1) After January 1, 1999, requests for new delegate areas be evaluated on an individual basis, taking into consideration conditions within both the requesting area and Alcoholics Anonymous (U.S./Canada).

- 2) The possible need for regional realignment be evaluated by following the existing "Suggested Guidelines for Changing Regional Boundaries" and that regional trustees should work together as a group to further discuss the process.

- The committee encouraged the trustees' Nominating Committee to continue to examine the role of appointed committee

members on trustees' committees. The committee would like to receive feedback for future committee discussions.

Committee Recommendations Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

LITERATURE

- That changes related to updating language in *Living Sober* be made.
- That changes related to medical and/or health information in *Living Sober* be made.
- That changes related to A.A.'s singleness of purpose in *Living Sober* be made.
- That the following insert be added to the booklet *Living Sober*, Chapter 29, "Different Kinds of A.A. Meetings" page 81, and placed after the text on Step Meetings:

"Cyberspace." With the increasing availability of the Internet, some of our members are having meetings in "cyberspace." Many of these members use this new medium to supplement their regular meetings, and some, due to either physical isolation or disability, cannot make regular meetings and find this new way of sharing to be an essential part of their sobriety.

Floor Actions Which Did Not Result in Conference Advisory Actions

Floor Action #1:

That the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. return the \$150,000 transportation subsidy received from the city of San Diego for the 1995 International Convention. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

Floor Action #2:

That the entire book *Living Sober* be sent to a subcommittee for evaluation and possible revision. **(Not adopted)**

Floor Action #3:

That group contributions to the General Service Office be included in the directories, i.e., Eastern, Western and Canadian. **(Conference voted not to consider)**

Tanya Every (Hawaii) and husband David (GV director) celebrated their 14th wedding anniversary Conference week—he gave her a jade ring and they sat together at lunch.